

Winter Pressure Plan

Document ID: DOC-002

Document Type: Operational Plan

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: 2026-01-01

Status: Active

Purpose

This plan supports operational resilience during periods of increased winter demand.

Winter pressure may include increased emergency attendances, respiratory illness, weather disruption, staff absence, reduced discharge capacity and increased bed occupancy.

Operational teams should monitor demand, staffing, bed availability, delayed discharge, emergency department performance and external disruption.

Appropriate actions may include additional operational coordination, expanded capacity where authorised, workforce contingency measures, discharge acceleration, escalation to system partners and enhanced monitoring of high-risk services.

Winter actions should remain proportionate to current demand and should be reviewed when pressure reduces or changes.